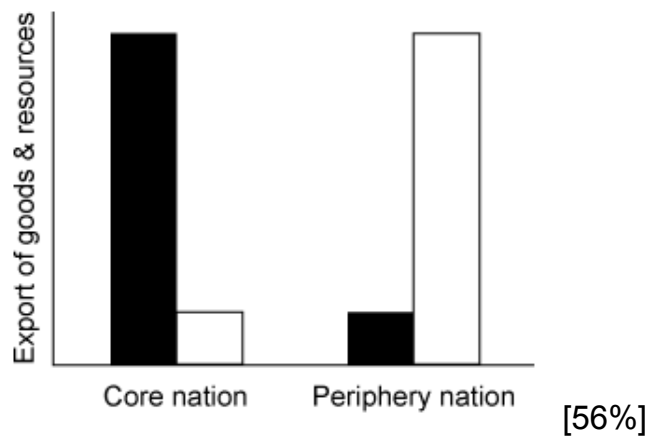
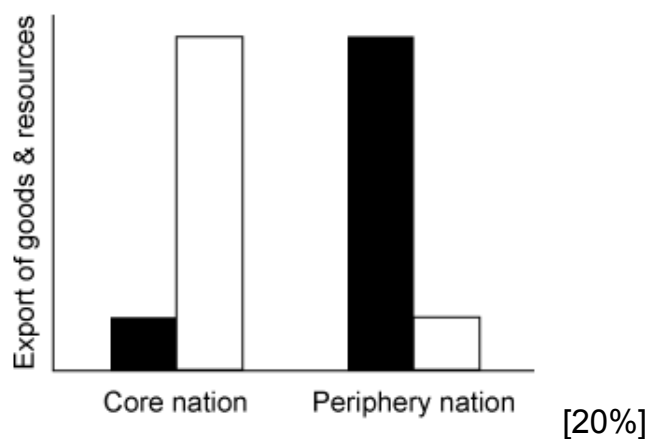


According to world systems theory, which of the following best illustrates global trends in exporting goods (black bars) and exporting resources (white bars)?

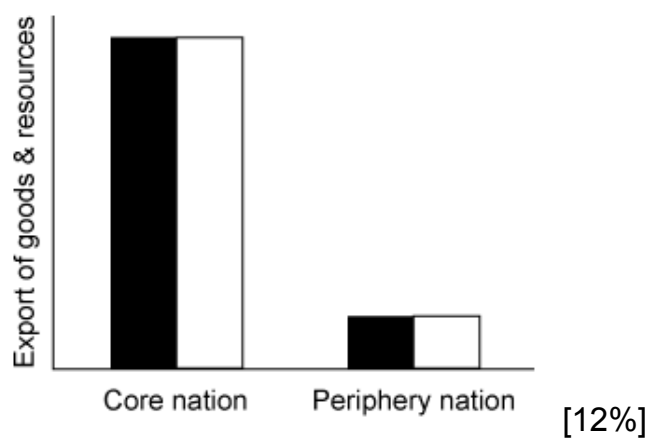
✓ ☒ A.



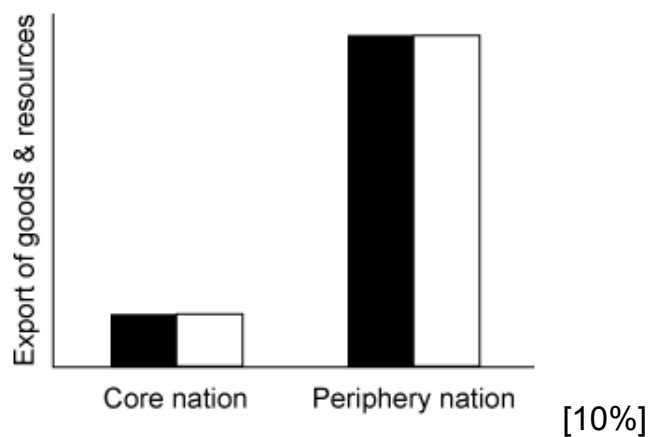
☐ B.



☐ C.



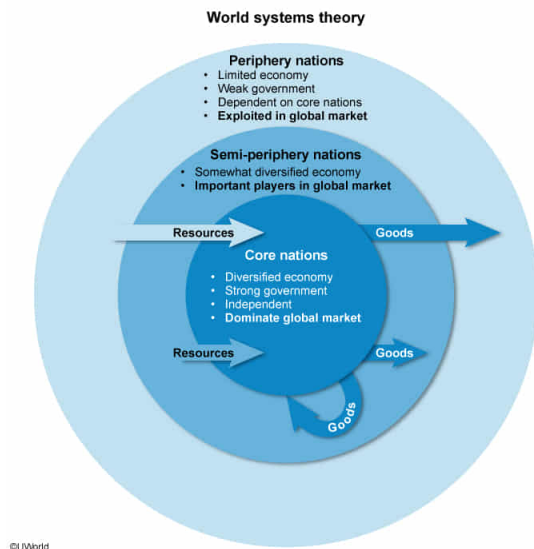
☐ D.



Correct

56% answered correctly

Explanation:



Globalization is defined in sociology as the process by which tangibles (eg, products) and intangibles (eg, values, ideas) **spread across** the **world**, primarily as a result of advances in **technology** and **communication**. Globalization has produced a world society with a shared global culture.

World systems theory is an economic theory of globalization that views the world as a **global economy** where some countries benefit at the expense of others:

- **Core nations** are wealthy with strong, diversified economies and centralized governments. Core nations (eg, United States, Western European countries) take resources from (exploit) poorer countries and lead the global economic market through the export of goods around the world.
- **Periphery nations** are poor and have weak governments and economies. Periphery nations (eg, Latin American, African countries) rely on the export of their resources (eg, oil, coffee, labor) to wealthier countries, making them dependent on (and exploited by) core nations.
- **Semi-periphery nations** (eg, India, Brazil) are between core and periphery nations, with economies that are relatively more diversified than those of periphery nations.

(Choices B, C, and D) Core nations lead the global economy, producing and exporting goods (represented by a tall black bar) across the globe while periphery nations export resources like raw materials and cheap labor (represented by a tall white bar) to core nations, best represented by the graph in [Choice A](#).

Educational objective:

Globalization is the process by which tangible products and intangible ideas/values spread across the world as a result of advances in technology and communication. An economic theory of globalization, world systems theory suggests the global economy is led by core nations that benefit at the expense of periphery nations.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401307
System:
Demographics and Social Structure

Standardized protocols, patient checklists, and clinical guidelines are meant to increase efficiency, calculability, predictability, and control in the clinical setting. However, critics of standardizing medicine suggest that these sorts of practices may lead to:

- ☐ A. a manifest function of medical care. [5%]
- ✓ ☒ B. the McDonaldisation of health care. [87%]
- ☐ C. an increase in the cultural capital of doctors. [1%]
- ☐ D. a decrease in the ascribed status of patients. [5%]

Correct

88% answered correctly

Explanation:

McDonaldization				
	Intended result	Unintended result	Fast-food example	Medicine example
Efficiency	↑ Optimization	↓ Individuality	Customer orders at register & cleans own table	Patient goes to a "Minute Clinic" for specific concerns
Calculability	↑ Quantity	↓ Quality	Increased amount of food can be produced	Increased number of patients can be seen
Predictability	↑ Uniformity ↑ Standardization	↓ Uniqueness	All restaurant chains appear the same, have same products	Standardized patient checklists make appointments uniform
Control	↑ Automation	↓ Skilled workforce	Pre-prepared, frozen food	Electronic patient portals allow patients to see test results

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In sociology, **bureaucracy** is defined as the most **efficient** and **rational** way to organize human behavior. A critical perspective of bureaucracy, **McDonaldization** describes the process by which extreme efficiency and rationalization produce negative consequences. The term stems from the fast-food industry, in which processes to increase efficiency, calculability, predictability, and control ensure that all franchised restaurants produce a similar, standardized product and experience.

McDonaldization describes when the following happens in society:

- **Efficiency** produces optimization at the **cost of individuality**.
- **Calculability** produces high quantities at the **expense of quality**.
- **Predictability** produces standardization at the **expense of uniqueness**.
- **Control** increases automation, **reducing** the need for a **skilled workforce**.

Standardized protocols, patient checklists, and clinical guidelines may increase efficiency, calculability, predictability, and control at the expense of patient care. Therefore, critics would most likely argue that McDonaldization of health care has occurred.

(Choice A) Manifest functions are the intended social outcomes of an institution. For example, the health care system is meant to take care of ill individuals in society. Latent functions are unintended outcomes, such as increasing disparity in health outcomes for

wealthy and poor individuals. Critics would be more likely to suggest that standardizing medicine leads to latent (not manifest) functions of health care.

(Choice C) Cultural capital describes the nonfinancial and nonsocial network assets that confer advantage in society (eg, a degree from a well-respected university). Standardizing medicine should not increase the cultural capital of physicians in any way.

(Choice D) Ascribed status is a position in society based on a social construct such as age, gender, or race/ethnicity. Standardizing medicine would likely *increase* the categorization of patients based on these constructs, thereby increasing (not decreasing) the use of ascribed patient status.

Educational objective:

McDonaldization is the process whereby efficiency reduces individuality, calculability reduces quality, predictability reduces uniqueness, and control reduces the need for a skilled workforce.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:401308

System:

Demographics and Social Structure

To assess the relationship between chronic disease and spatial inequality in a given area, researchers systematically observe and interview individuals in their communities. This is best described as which of the following?

- ☐ A. Experimental design [5%]
- ✓ ☒ B. Ethnographic study [75%]
- ☐ C. Social network analysis [13%]
- ☐ D. Content analysis [5%]

Correct

74% answered correctly

Explanation:

Study methods	
Qualitative	Quantitative
• Information gathered subjectively to determine if there are patterns or themes • Best used for studying complex processes, such as human social behavior • Examples: Ethnography, focus group	• Data collected objectively & analyzed statistically to answer a specific question • Best used for determining relationships between definable variables • Examples: Randomized controlled study, correlational study

Human behavior can be studied using quantitative or qualitative methods. Quantitative research starts with a hypothesis (a testable question) and objectively collects data that can be analyzed statistically. Quantitative methods attempt to eliminate all variables except those of interest. Because it is impossible to control all of the variables in a person's natural environment, sociological phenomena are most often assessed using qualitative methods. Qualitative research involves subjectively gathering information to determine the presence of a pattern.

Ethnography is a qualitative method for the **scientific study of human social phenomena**. Using observation and interviews, ethnographies study people in their natural environments (within their own communities) and provide descriptive information about the cultures, behaviors, norms, and values in a given geographic location.

Spatial inequality is the unequal geographical distribution of wealth resulting in the concentration of health-compromising factors (eg, pollution, crime) in lower-income neighborhoods. Researchers systematically observing and interviewing individuals in their communities to assess the relationship between chronic disease and spatial inequality are using ethnographic methods to study this complex social phenomenon.

(Choice A) An experimental design is a quantitative approach whereby the researcher manipulates independent variables to measure their effect on dependent variables. It would be unethical to use an experimental design to assess the effects of spatial inequality on chronic disease as certain subjects would knowingly be exposed to substandard living conditions.

(Choice C) Social network analysis is an epidemiological technique mapping connections between individuals to study the spread of communicable diseases in a population. Chronic diseases are more complex and do not lend themselves to social network analysis.

(Choice D) Content analysis is a qualitative technique used to examine the text and images involved in human communication. It is used to assess one-on-one verbal communication, such as interview transcripts, or more widespread forms of communication, such as online content. Content analysis

does not involve observations of individuals in their social environments.

Educational objective:

Ethnography scientifically studies individuals in their own communities to learn about culture, norms, and values within an area. Qualitative methods (eg, observation, interviews) are best for studying human social phenomena.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401309
System:
Demographics and Social Structure